



Colour coding appointments

when you are scheduling an appointment, click a colour in the Label list.

Rules Rule

Outlook has a powerful rules system to notify when an important mail, such as from your fiancé or your boss, comes in. Additionally, you can make Outlook automatically move e-mail into predefined folders such as 'Mailing Lists', 'Family Mail' and more. This will help de-clutter your inbox and make your e-mails more manageable.



Illustration: Mahesh Benkar

To create a rule, click Rules Wizard. You can either customise on the Tools menu, one of the sample rules in Outlook, or build one from the scratch. Most rules operate on messages as they arrive or are sent, but you can create a rule and select it to run on messages in your Inbox



Readers' Tips

MS Excel

Close Workbooks Fast



Need to leave your desk suddenly but have 10 worksheets open in Excel? Try this—Click the File menu while keeping the **SHIFT** key pressed on your keyboard. Excel will now reveal a 'Close All' menu item, clicking which will close all open worksheets, while prompting for a save where applicable.

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MS Word

Customising Your "Normal" Template



Does your work require sending large number of letters on your letterhead? What you can do is open the normal.dot template file from a path like "C:\Documents and Settings\Saurabh Kumar\Application Data\Microsoft\Templates". Any changes you make in this document will appear in any new documents you make in Word. You can use the header/footer fields to add custom letter head graphics, page numbering, date/time etc. and these will appear every time you open a new document.

Shortcuts to Useful Word Features

Did you know that the status bar, that area at the bottom of Word documents where the page number appears, also provides shortcuts to a number of very useful features? Here are a few you may want to use:

To open the Find and Replace dialog box, double-click any location indicator on the status bar, such as the page number or section number.

- ▶ To turn the macro recorder on or off, double-click REC.
- ▶ To turn the Track Changes feature on or off, double-click TRK.
- ▶ To turn extend selection mode on or off, double-click EXT.
- ▶ To turn overtype mode on or off, double-click OVR.
- ▶ To change the language format of selected text, double-click Language.

(or other folders). In fact, one of the easiest ways to create a rule is by using an existing

message in your Inbox. Open the message, and on the Actions menu click Create

To resolve errors in grammar or spelling, double-click the Spelling and Grammar Status.

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MS Outlook

Important Office data files



At the time of making your regular backup, it is essential to know where the important data files of MS Office are kept. Here are the important ones:

- ▶ .pab files are Microsoft Outlook address book files.
- ▶ .pst files are Microsoft Outlook mail, contacts, tasks and calendar files book files.
- ▶ .rwz files are the Microsoft Outlook rules wizard files.
- ▶ Locate the file by using the Windows find tool. Click **Start > Find > Files or Folders**.

In the Named box type *.pab(or whatever you are searching for from above) in the Look in box, ensure it is looking on the drive that Microsoft Office is located (generally the C: drive). Click Find Now

This should locate the file you are looking for, if present. Ensure that you have completely closed your copy of Microsoft Office. Once this file is located copy the file to an alternate drive or backup media.

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MS Access

Automagically normalise tables



One of the most useful but unnoticed feature of Access is Analyze. It is divided into three options.

Table Analyzer: This feature attempts to analyze your table for repeated data, recommends and splits the tables to generate BCNF normalised table structure. The tool is good for a quick survey of the tables or for newbies, as its suggestions are usually good and based on logic.

Performance Analyzer: It analyses and suggests modification in the structure of the database to optimize the performance of database. The wizard will attempt to locate logical errors such as incorrect data types and more.

Documentor: This one is used to create the documentation of the database structure, which can be useful and a real time saver for quick report generation.

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Rule. The Rules Wizard will include details about your message, such as sender and



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